



Participant Information Sheet

Title of Study: How do people construct and attribute mental states to large language models, and how do relational, experiential and linguistic factors affect this process?

We would like to invite you to take part in a research study. Before you decide you need to understand why the research is being done and what it would involve for you. Please take time to read the following information carefully. Ask questions if anything you read is not clear or if you would like more information. Take time to decide whether or not to take part.

WHO WE ARE AND WHAT THIS STUDY IS ABOUT

This study is being conducted by Roberto Sestini, an undergraduate at the London Interdisciplinary School. Your responses will help us understand the ways in which interaction with general-purpose LLMs affects anthropomorphism of LLMs, that is prescribing human characteristics, specially states of mind, to AI such as ChatGPT and Gemini.

WHAT WILL TAKING PART INVOLVE?

This survey is designed to be quick and easy to complete - it should take no more than 5 **minutes** of your time and **all required questions are demographic information, multiple choice or Likert scales**. After answering the demographic questions you will outline your experience using LLMs, answer some questions to assess your understanding of how LLMs work, be assessed on your tendency to anthropomorphise generally and finally on your anthropomorphism of LLMs specifically.

WHY HAVE YOU BEEN INVITED TO TAKE PART?

Anyone over 18 qualifies for this study.

EXPENSES AND PAYMENTS

N/A

DO YOU HAVE TO TAKE PART?

Participation is completely voluntary, and you have the right to refuse participation, refuse any question or withdraw at any time without any consequence whatsoever.

WHAT ARE THE POSSIBLE RISKS AND BENEFITS OF TAKING PART?

It is possible that the survey may touch on sensitive topics such as parasocial relationships. If you feel that your mental wellbeing has been affected by any issue that has come up in this study, please contact the Head of Student Support (student.support@lis.ac.uk) if you are a current LIS student. Otherwise, you are recommended to contact The Samaritans on 116 123 for a free call with a trained volunteer, or text SHOUT to 85258 for text-based support.

We do not foresee any direct benefits for you as an individual.

WILL TAKING PART BE CONFIDENTIAL?

Your input will be anonymised in any publication or presentation that may arise from this research. However, non-anonymised data in the form of signed consent forms will be retained as part of the research process. You will generate a numerical identifier (participant number) from your personal information, which will be used to reference all of the data collected from you. A document which will holds your participant number will be stored securely according to LIS guidelines, and will not be shared other than if required with supervisor of this research.

HOW WILL INFORMATION YOU PROVIDE BE RECORDED, STORED AND PROTECTED?

Signed consent forms or printed documents containing interview or focus group data will be stored securely according to LIS guidelines (e.g. in a locked filing cabinet on university campus or, if electronic, these will be retained in or as password-protected files), until all participating student researchers have completed their degree.

Your responses to the questionnaire will be anonymised and stored for a further two years in a secure cloud-based data storage system. The data will be password protected and will be retained for a further two years after data collection.

Under freedom of information legislation, you are entitled to access the information you have provided at any time.

WHAT WILL HAPPEN TO THE RESULTS OF THE STUDY?

The overall findings from our analysis may be used in assessments, included in a publication (such as a journal article or blog post), shared in a conference presentation, or used for teaching purposes in the future. No information that could identify any individual will be included in these findings, unless you have asked to be named.

WHO HAS REVIEWED THE STUDY?

Research for this study has undergone checks for ethical research, and where required been reviewed by ethical review board in accordance with the LIS Research Ethics Policy.

WHO SHOULD YOU CONTACT FOR FURTHER INFORMATION?

The faculty members overseeing this small student-led project are Anson Cheung (anson.cheung@lis.ac.uk) If you wish to report a concern about how this study has been conducted, please contact the named individual above.